



Passion Lessons

Student-led lessons for tutor time: a student who loves something teaches the form about it, with a short introduction on why they love it, some background, and activities they have designed themselves. They sign up for a date you have set on a shared spreadsheet, show you their plan the week before, and teach for anything from twenty minutes in Year 7 to an hour in the sixth form. Nobody has to do one, and they run as often as you choose, once a month or once a half term. Being the expert in the room gives the student teaching real confidence, and the rest of the form learns about something they would never have picked.

Before you start. You approve every topic before it goes on the sheet, and look over the plan the week before. Steer a student away, kindly, from anything that could upset somebody in the room or that shares more about their own life than they might want known later, and help them find the part of it that works for the whole form.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	For you: how long each year group can manage, what to check, and what to do if it goes wrong.
Page 3	The student guide: what a passion lesson needs. One for anybody thinking of signing up.
Pages 4 and 5	The planner, with a reflection on the back. One for each student teaching, back to back.
Page 6	Exit tickets, six to a sheet. Five sheets covers a form of thirty.
The spreadsheet	The sign-up sheet. You put the dates in, then share it with the form.

What you do, and when

When	What you do	What to print
Start of term	Type your dates into the spreadsheet. Tell the form what a passion lesson is and share the sheet.	Page 3
When somebody signs up	Talk the topic through with them, mark it approved on the sheet, and give them the planner.	Pages 4 and 5
The week before	Go through the planner together: the timings, anything they will show on screen, and what they need on the day.	Nothing
On the day	Hand over the room, sit at the side and keep time. Exit tickets go out for the last three minutes, then to the student to read before they fill in the reflection on their planner.	Page 6

Worth knowing

- Students make everything themselves, slides included. Your job is to check it, not to build it.
- If nobody signs up at first, teach the first one yourself, on something you love.

Set the first date, and ask who has something they would love to teach.





Running a passion lesson

For you rather than the student: how long each year group can manage, what to check before the day, and what to do when it does not go to plan.

HOW LONG, BY YEAR GROUP

YEAR GROUP	HOW LONG	WHAT FITS IN IT
Year 7	20 minutes	A short introduction, a little background and one activity. Hands-on works best.
Year 8 and 9	20 to 30 minutes	Room for two activities, or one longer one. A quiz goes down well.
Year 10 and 11	30 to 45 minutes	The background can go deeper, and one activity can be in pairs or groups.
Sixth form	30 minutes to an hour	A full lesson if your slot allows, with proper time for questions.

BEFORE THE DAY, CHECK THAT

- ☐ It is something they know well and care about, rather than something they think will impress.
- ☐ Nothing in it could upset somebody in the room or single anybody out.
- ☐ You have seen anything they will show on screen first: every video, picture and song.
- ☐ The timings on the planner add up to the length they signed up for.
- ☐ Anything they need, whether a projector, printing, space or equipment, is sorted by the day before.
- ☐ Anything they bring in is allowed in school, and food follows your school's rules on allergies.

IF IT DOES NOT GO TO PLAN

WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT TO DO
They freeze at the start	Ask them the first question on their planner, why they love it. Nearly everybody can answer that, and it gets them going.
It runs short	Open it up to questions from the form, or ask them what they would have added with more time.
It runs long	Tell them quietly when there are five minutes left, so they can skip to the ending. The exit tickets still go out.
The form is not listening	Step in once, briefly, the way you would for a visiting speaker, then hand the room straight back.
Something personal comes up	Thank them, move the lesson on, and talk to them on their own afterwards. Pass on anything that worries you in the usual way.





Your passion lesson

You get to teach the form about something you love. You plan it and make everything for it yourself, and your tutor helps you check it. Here is what it needs.

THE FOUR PARTS EVERY PASSION LESSON HAS

1 Why I love it

Start by telling the form how you got into it and why it matters to you. A minute or two is plenty, and an object, a photo or a story helps.

2 The background

What does everybody need to know first? Pick three or four things and explain them as if nobody in the room has heard of it.

3 The activities

Something the form does, not only something they watch. It could be a quiz, a vote, a puzzle, a challenge in pairs, or a go at the thing itself.

4 The ending

Sum it up in one sentence and take questions. Then your tutor gives out the exit tickets, so the form can tell you what they learned.

HOW LONG IT SHOULD BE

YEAR 7
20 minutes

YEAR 8 AND 9
20 to 30 minutes

YEAR 10 AND 11
30 to 45 minutes

SIXTH FORM
30 minutes to an hour

IDEAS FOR YOUR ACTIVITIES

A quiz

Guess what it is

Have a go

Vote or rank

Spot the difference

A challenge in pairs

Before and after

Teach your partner

STEP BY STEP

1 Sign up

Put your name, your topic, how long and what you need next to a free date on the sign-up sheet.

2 Talk to your tutor

Your tutor checks the topic with you and marks it approved.

3 Plan it

Fill in your planner, then make your slides and anything else you need.

4 Show your tutor

A week before, go through your planner and your slides together.

5 Practise once

Out loud, with a timer, so you know it fits.

6 Teach it

Then read your exit tickets and fill in the reflection on your planner.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Talk to the form rather than to the board, and ask them questions as you go.
- Keep your slides to a few words and a picture. You are the one explaining it.
- Everything you show on screen needs checking by your tutor first.
- Being nervous is normal. The form is on your side, and your tutor is in the room.





My passion lesson: the plan

Fill this in before you make anything. Your tutor goes through it with you a week before your lesson.

NAME

THE DATE OF MY LESSON

1 My passion is

HOW LONG

☐ 20 minutes

☐ 30 minutes

☐ 40 minutes

☐ 45 minutes

☐ An hour

2 Why I love it

How did you get into it, and why does it matter to you? This is how your lesson starts.

3 The background: what everybody needs to know first

Three things, explained as if nobody in the room has heard of it.

1

2

3

4 The activities

Something the form does, not only something they watch.

ACTIVITY	WHAT THE FORM DOES	MINUTES	WHAT I NEED

5 The ending

Your lesson in one sentence, to say before you take questions.





Getting ready, and afterwards

The top half is for the week before your lesson. Fill in the reflection once you have taught it and read your exit tickets.

MY TIMINGS

PART	MINUTES
Why I love it	
The background	
Activity 1	
Activity 2	
Activity 3	
The ending	
Total	

The total should match the length you signed up for.

WHAT I NEED ON THE DAY

- ☐ The projector or screen
- ☐ Printing
- ☐ The tables moved
- ☐ Things I am bringing in
- ☐ Something else: _____

CHECKED WITH MY TUTOR ON

MY TUTOR'S INITIALS

Afterwards: my reflection

1 How confident did I feel?

BEFORE not at all **1** **2** **3** **4** **5** very

AFTER not at all **1** **2** **3** **4** **5** very

2 What went well

3 What I would change next time

4 What I learned from doing it

About the topic, about teaching, or about yourself.

5 The exit ticket I liked best, and why





Exit tickets

Six to a sheet. Hand them out for the last three minutes, then give them to the student who taught the lesson, to keep.



PASSION LESSONS · EXIT TICKET

What I am taking away

Today's lesson was on _____

One thing I learned

One question I would ask



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